Invoice Form Design Report

How to design the invoice-creation form for SN Advertising, based on the three sample invoices (Araliya, Chamara – Ran FM, Chamara – Ridam FM) · Prepared: 2026-11-09

1. Purpose

SN Advertising creates advertisements and campaigns for many different companies and bills each of them. Today every invoice is made by editing an Excel file by hand, which leads to mix-ups. This report studies the three sample invoices and defines exactly which fields the invoice form needs, which are typed, which are chosen from a list, which are calculated automatically, and which rules apply.

2. What the Three Sample Invoices Show

2.1 Field-by-field comparison

Invoice field	Araliya (Aug 2026)	Chamara – Ran FM (Oct 2026)	Chamara – Ridam FM (Oct 2026)
Advertiser name	Araliya Lands and Homes (Pvt) Ltd	CHAMARA MOTORS AND STICKERS CENTER.	CHAMARA MOTORS AND STICKERS CENTER
Advertiser address	Kadawatha 11850	31, Kandy Road Kirillwala, Kadawatha	31, Kandy Road Kirillwala, Kadawatha
Client VAT No	none	100958996 - 7000	none
Invoice date	2026-08-12	2026-09-30	2026-09-30
Invoice No	23458	23466	4415/RFM (looks swapped, see 2.2)
Reg. No	2588/CM	2645/RFR	23465 (looks swapped)
Product	blank	blank	blank
"VAT NO" next to Product	none	114094498-7000	blank
Your Ref	blank	blank	blank

Invoice field	Araliya (Aug 2026)	Chamara – Ran FM (Oct 2026)	Chamara – Ridam FM (Oct 2026)
Date of Advertising	2026-08-12	OCT - NOV 2026	OCT - NOV 2026
Description	Video Campaign with Presenter (3 Clips)	SPONSER SHIP PACKEGE ON RUN FM	SPONSER SHIP PACKEGE ON RIDAM FM EVENING SHOW
Amount (Rs.)	125,000	300,000	200,000
VAT	none	54,000 (18%)	none
Total / Grand Total	125,000	354,000	200,000
Special note	75% Advance Payment to Proceed with Work	none	none
Payment instruction	Cheque to SN ADVERTISING, plus bank transfer details (Seylan Bank, Kadawatha)	Cheque to HARIPARA(PVT)LTD	Cheque to HARIPARA(PVT)LTD

2.2 Findings that shape the form

1. **The letterhead never changes.** All three show the same SN Advertising address, phones and email at the top. Only the payment instruction at the bottom changes (SN Advertising vs HARIPARA (PVT) LTD). So the form needs a "Issued / payable to" choice that controls the footer, not the letterhead.
2. **Invoice No looks like a running number.** 23458, 23465 and 23466 fit one sequence. In the Ridam FM file the Invoice No and Reg. No values appear to have been typed into each other's boxes (it shows 4415/RFM and 23465). The form must make that impossible by assigning the invoice number itself.
3. **Reg. No looks like a job reference** in the form number/code (2588/CM, 2645/RFR, 4415/RFM). This is an inference and must be confirmed with the client (see section 10).
4. **VAT is optional per invoice.** The same client (Chamara) has one invoice with VAT and one without. VAT is 18% of the amount (300,000 × 18% = 54,000).

5. **Two different VAT numbers appear.** The number labelled CLIENT VAT NO belongs to the advertiser. The "VAT NO" under Product is probably the issuing company's own VAT number, shown only when VAT is charged. To be confirmed.
6. **"Date of Advertising" is a date or a period.** One invoice has a single date, the others have a period (OCT - NOV 2026). It must accept both.
7. **Product, Your Ref and Total vs Grand Total** are blank or duplicated on every sample. Product and Your Ref should be optional; Total and Grand Total can be merged into one calculated figure.
8. **Typing errors** appear in the sample text ("SPONSER SHIP PACKEGE", "Discription"). A fixed catalog of services removes this.
9. **One line per invoice** in all three samples, but the form should still allow several lines.

3. Form Structure (Sections, Top to Bottom)

Section	Purpose	Filled by
A. Invoice header	Number, date, issued/payable-to choice	Mostly automatic
B. Client (advertiser)	Who is being billed	Pick from list; details auto-fill
C. Job references	Product, Reg. No, Your Ref	Typed or picked
D. Line items	What work, for which period, how much	Pick from catalog, edit price
E. Totals	Subtotal, VAT, Grand Total	Automatic
F. Notes and payment terms	Advance note, cheque and bank instructions	Chosen from templates
G. Preview and save	Check the PDF layout	Review, then save

On a phone the sections stack as one scrolling page with a sticky "Total" bar at the bottom; on a computer sections A and B sit side by side.

4. Field Specification

Required fields are marked *.

4.1 Section A – Invoice header

Field	Type	Behaviour	Example
Invoice No *	Auto text	Assigned by the system as the next running number. Cannot be edited. Never reused.	23467
Invoice date *	Date picker	Defaults to today. Shown as a normal date.	2026-09-30
Issue under *	Dropdown	SN Advertising / HARIPARA (PVT) LTD. Defaults to the client's usual choice. Controls cheque payee, bank details and the issuer VAT number in the footer.	HARIPARA (PVT) LTD
Status	Dropdown	Draft / Issued / Paid / Void. Starts as Draft.	Draft

4.2 Section B – Client (advertiser)

Field	Type	Behaviour	Example
Client *	Searchable dropdown	Choose an existing client, or "Add new client" without leaving the form.	Chamara Motors and Stickers Center
Client name (printed)	Auto, read-only	Copied from the client record.	CHAMARA MOTORS AND STICKERS CENTER
Address	Auto, read-only	Copied from the client record.	31, Kandy Road Kirillwala, Kadawatha
Client VAT No	Auto, read-only	Shown only if the client has one.	100958996 - 7000

When the invoice is saved, the name, address and VAT number are **copied into the invoice** so later changes to the client never alter old invoices.

4.3 Section C – Job references

Field	Type	Behaviour	Example
Product	Text, optional	Name of the product or brand being advertised.	(blank in samples)

Field	Type	Behaviour	Example
Reg. No	Text, optional	Job or registration reference. Pattern `number/CODE` to be confirmed.	2645/RFR
Your Ref	Text, optional	The client's own purchase order or reference.	(blank in samples)

4.4 Section D – Line items (repeatable)

Field	Type	Behaviour	Example
Service *	Dropdown from catalog	Fills the description and default price. A "Custom" option allows free text.	Sponsorship package – Run FM
Description *	Text	Pre-filled from the service, editable. Spell-checked.	Sponsorship package on Run FM
Date / period of advertising *	Date or date range	A single date or a range, or free text such as OCT - NOV 2026.	Oct–Nov 2026
Quantity	Number	Defaults to 1.	1
Unit price (Rs.) *	Money	Pre-filled from the client's price or catalog, editable.	300,000.00
Line amount	Calculated	Quantity × unit price.	300,000.00
Add line / remove line	Buttons	For invoices with more than one task.	

4.5 Section E – Totals (all calculated)

Field	Behaviour
Subtotal	Sum of all line amounts.
Charge VAT?	Checkbox. Defaults from the client record but can be changed per invoice.
VAT rate	Taken from settings (currently 18%). Shown only when VAT is charged.
VAT amount	Subtotal × VAT rate, rounded to 2 decimals.

Field	Behaviour
Grand Total	Subtotal + VAT amount. One figure replaces the duplicate Total and Grand Total.
Amount in words	Optional, printed on the PDF.

4.6 Section F – Notes and payment instructions

Field	Type	Behaviour	Example
Advance payment	Checkbox + percent	If ticked, prints the advance note and can show the advance amount.	75%
Note	Dropdown of templates + free text	Standard sentences, editable.	75% Advance Payment to Proceed with Work
Payment instructions	Auto, read-only	Taken from the "Issue under" choice: cheque payee text, and bank transfer details where set.	Cheques should be drawn in favour of HARIPARA (PVT) LTD. and crossed "ACCOUNT PAYEE" only
Issuer VAT No	Auto	Printed only when VAT is charged.	114094498-7000
Authorized signature	Auto	Signature image from settings.	

5. Calculation Rules

1. Line amount = quantity × unit price.
2. Subtotal = sum of line amounts.
3. VAT amount = subtotal × VAT rate, only if "Charge VAT" is ticked; otherwise 0.
4. Grand Total = subtotal + VAT amount.
5. All amounts use 2 decimals and the same rounding rule everywhere.
6. Totals update live as the user types.

Worked examples from the samples

Invoice	Subtotal	VAT	Grand Total
Araliya – Video Campaign (3 Clips)	125,000	0 (not charged)	125,000
Chamara – Run FM Sponsorship	300,000	54,000 (18%)	354,000
Chamara – Ridam FM Sponsorship	200,000	0 (not charged)	200,000

The system must reproduce these three results exactly; they should be the first test cases.

6. Automatic Behaviour (What the User Should Never Type)

- Invoice number (next running number)
- Client name, address and VAT number (from the client record)
- Cheque payee and bank details (from the "Issue under" choice)
- Line amounts, VAT, Grand Total
- Letterhead, signature and layout
- Default price, description and note (from catalog and client defaults)

This is what removes the Excel mix-ups: the user only chooses the client, the work, the period and whether VAT applies.

7. Validation Rules

Rule	Message to the user
Client must be selected	Please choose a client.
At least one line item	Add at least one service.
Unit price greater than 0	Enter a price.
Date of advertising cannot be empty	Enter the date or period.
VAT ticked but client has no VAT number	Warning only: the client VAT No is blank. Continue?
VAT ticked but issuing company has no VAT number	Cannot save: add the VAT number in settings.

Rule	Message to the user
Invoice number already exists	Blocked (the system should make this impossible).
Editing an issued invoice	Not allowed. Void it and create a new one.

8. The Companion "Add New Client" Form

So that the invoice form can pull details automatically, a client must be stored once with:

- Client name *, address *
- Client VAT number (optional)
- Charge VAT by default (yes / no)
- Default "Issue under" company (SN Advertising or HARIPARA)
- Contact person, phone, WhatsApp, email (optional)
- Default advance % and default note (optional)
- A short client code (for example CHM, ARL)

9. Sample Data Entered Through the New Form

To show the form works, each sample would be created like this:

Form field	Araliya	Chamara – Run FM	Chamara – Ridam FM
Client	Araliya Lands and Homes (Pvt) Ltd	Chamara Motors and Stickers Center	Chamara Motors and Stickers Center
Issue under	SN Advertising	HARIPARA (PVT) LTD	HARIPARA (PVT) LTD
Invoice date	2026-08-12	2026-09-30	2026-09-30
Reg. No	2588/CM	2645/RFR	4415/RFM
Service	Video Campaign with Presenter (3 Clips)	Sponsorship Package – Run FM	Sponsorship Package – Ridam FM Evening Show
Period	2026-08-12	OCT - NOV 2026	OCT - NOV 2026
Unit price	125,000	300,000	200,000

Form field	Araliya	Chamara – Run FM	Chamara – Ridam FM
Charge VAT	No	Yes	No
Advance	75%	none	none
Grand Total	125,000	354,000	200,000

10. Questions to Confirm with the Client

These decide the final field behaviour and should be answered before building.

1. **Invoice No:** Is it a plain running number (23458, 23465, 23466)? What is the latest number issued, and should the new system continue from it?
2. **Reg. No:** What does it represent, and what do the codes after the slash (CM, RFR, RFM) mean? Is it entered by staff or generated?
3. **Ridam FM sheet:** Please confirm that 23465 is the invoice number and 4415/RFM the Reg. No, i.e. that the two were typed into the wrong boxes.
4. **Product and Your Ref:** Are they ever used? Should they stay optional?
5. **Two VAT numbers:** Please confirm that 114094498-7000 is the issuing company's number (HARIPARA) and 100958996-7000 is the advertiser's.
6. **VAT rule:** Is VAT charged only on invoices issued under HARIPARA (PVT) LTD, only to clients with a VAT number, or decided case by case? Is it always 18%?
7. **Issue under:** Which company issues which invoice? Is there a rule by client, by service, or is it chosen each time? Are there more companies than SN Advertising and HARIPARA?
8. **Payment instructions:** Should bank transfer details (shown only on the Araliya sample) appear on every invoice? What are the HARIPARA bank details?
9. **Advance payments:** For "75% Advance", is a second invoice issued for the balance, or is it only a note?
10. **Date of advertising:** Is it a single date, a date range, or free text? Which format do clients expect?
11. **Total and Grand Total:** Can they be merged into one Grand Total?
12. **Several lines:** How often does one invoice include more than one task? Is quantity × unit price needed?
13. **Service list:** Please provide the list of services offered (video campaigns, radio sponsorship, stickers, etc.) with usual prices.

14. **Client list:** Please provide all clients with name, address, VAT number and whether VAT applies.
15. **Language and layout:** English only? Keep the current letterhead exactly? Is a signature image allowed on the PDF?

11. Next Steps

1. Get the answers to section 10.
2. Collect the full client list and service list.
3. Build a clickable prototype of the form with these three invoices as test data.
4. Compare the generated PDFs and totals with the original Excel files.
5. Adjust the form from staff feedback, then build the full system.